Hanh-Linh (Linh) Tran

Department of Political Science
Emory University
1555 Dickey Drive
Atlanta GA 30322

Phone: (+1) 470-9295605
Email: hanh.linh.tran@emory.edu
Website: https://hanhlinhtran.github.io/

Research Interests

Political Violence, Repression, Human Rights, Religion, Southeast Asia

Teaching Interests

Comparative Politics, International Relations, International Organizations, Political Violence, Southeast Asian Politics, Research Design

Education

Ph.D. Candidate, Political Science, Emory University (2027 expected)

Committee: Renard Sexton (Chair), Nahomi Ichino, Luis Martinez, Edmund Malesky (External)

M.A., Political Science, Central European University (2021)

Advisor: Gabor Simonovits

B.A., English for International Relations, Diplomatic Academy of Viet Nam (2019)

Working Papers

1. "The Legacy of Persecution of Religious Minorities on Protests: Evidence From Vietnamese Catholics," *Dissertation Chapter*.

   Presented at: APSA 2026, MPSA 2026.

   Scheduled: ESOC 2026, SoWEPS-11 F2026, ISA 2027, Virtual Workshop in Historical Political Economy 2027, CES 2027.

2. "Human Rights Improvements and Public Support for Security Cooperation with Abusers," *Under Review*.

3. "Family Counts: Decision-Making of South Vietnamese Military Officers," with Linchuan Zhang.

4. "Long-Run Impacts of Autonomy," with Mai Nguyen and Renard Sexton.

5. "International and Domestic Election Observers in Serbian Election," with Sinisa Miric and Anthony DeMattee.

6. "Traditional or Communist Values? Why Traditional Values May Not Explain Support for LGBT Candidates in Single-Party Regimes," with Paul Schuler.

Work in Progress

1. "The Politics of Gray Zone Coercion: The South China Sea Data Initiative (2012–2025)", with Tatsuya Koyama and Renard Sexton.
2. "Mobilization for Immigrant and Refugee Relief in Thailand"
3. "Priests' Advocacy for Migrant Workers' Rights in Taiwan"

Awards, Fellowships, and Grants

LGS Competitive PDS Funds, Emory University, $2100 (2026)

IHS Humane Studies Fellowship, $3000 (2026)

J-PAL's Governance Initiative Travel/Proposal Development Grant, $6018 (2024)

SEAREG Pre-Dissertation Fellowship, $4500 (2023)

SEAREG Conference Travel Grant, Southeast Asia Research Group, $700 (2025), $500 (2023)

Laney Graduate School Fellowship, Emory University (2022–2027), $2500/year

Master's Scholarship, Central European University (2020)

Full scholarship for Development Studies 1, Oslo Metropolitan University (2019)

Academic Scholarship, Diplomatic Academy of Viet Nam (2015–2019)

Raymond E. Reamey Memorial Fund Scholarship, Diplomatic Academy of Viet Nam (2018)

Conference and Workshop Presentations

Southern Workshop in Empirical Political Science: 2026 (full presentation), 2024 (poster presentation)

Empirical Studies of Conflict: 2026 (scheduled), 2025

American Political Science Association: 2026

International Studies Association: 2027 (scheduled)

Midwest Political Science Association: 2026

Southeast Asia Research Group: 2025 (poster presentation)

Carolinas Conflict Consortium: 2025

New Directions in Civil- Military Research Workshop (Emory University): 2025

4th Asian Summer School on Political Parties and Democracy (National Chengchi University): 2024

Fieldwork

1. Vietnam: Spring 2025 (interview and field survey), Winter 2024 (funded by J-PAL GI), Summer 2024 (National Archives II, with Linchuan Zhang, funded by the Halle Institute), Summer 2023 (funded by SEAREG)
2. Thailand: Summer 2025
3. Taiwan: Summer 2025

Teaching Experience

Co-instructor: International Organizations (Fall 2025)

Teaching Assistant: Principles of Political Science (Fall 2026), Research Design & Methods (Spring 2025)

Professional Experience

South China Sea Data Initiative, Research Assistant (2020–2025)

Development and Policies Research Center (Hanoi, Vietnam), Researcher (2022)

Mekong Development Research Institute (Hanoi, Vietnam), Research Intern (2019–2020)

Institute for Studies of Society, Economy and Environment (Hanoi, Vietnam), Intern (2018–2019)

Service

Co-organizer, Junior Scholars in Quantitative Conflict Workshop (Fall 2026, Spring 2026, Fall 2025)

Program Committee, ESOC 2025 Annual Meeting (October 2025)

Co-founder, European Horizons at CEU (2021)

Skills

Language: English (fluent), Vietnamese (native), French (B2)

Software: R, LaTeX, QGIS, ODK, SurveyCTO, Qualtrics

References

Renard Sexton
Department of Political Science
Emory University
renard.sexton@emory.edu

Nahomi Ichino
Department of Political Science
Emory University
nahomi.ichino@emory.edu

Luis Martinez
Department of Political Science
Emory University
luismartinez@emory.edu

Minh Trinh
Department of Government
The University of Texas at Austin
mdtrinh@austin.utexas.edu